

# Cross-System Trust Module (CSTM)

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**Governed Space:** Cross-System Trust  
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**Subcategory:** Autonomous Operational Governance  
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## Canonical Definition

**Cross-System Trust Module (CSTM)** defines the structural conditions under which autonomous operational systems establish, evaluate, preserve, and govern trustworthy operational relationships across multiple autonomous systems and operational environments.

CSTM governs cross-system trust.

The module establishes the governance conditions required to ensure that autonomous operational actors interact only within justified, verifiable, and continuously governed trust relationships.

Compatibility enables interaction.

Trust enables reliable cooperation.

CSTM governs that trust.

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## Module Operational Role

CSTM defines the cross-system trust layer of ACPS.

Its role is to preserve justified operational trust between autonomous operational actors operating across heterogeneous ecosystems.

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# Module Operational Space

CSTM governs:

- cross-system trust,
- inter-system trust,
- trusted autonomous cooperation,
- operational trust relationships,
- trust validation,
- governed trust exchange,
- autonomous ecosystem trust,
- continuous trust governance.

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## Module Function

The module applies wherever autonomous operational systems must establish and maintain trustworthy operational relationships across organizational, technological, or operational boundaries.

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## Minimum Implementation Framework

### 1. Define the Cross-System Trust Object

Identify which autonomous operational relationships require governed trust.

### 2. Define Trust Conditions

Establish governance conditions governing trust establishment, evaluation, preservation, and reassessment.

### 3. Define Trust Failure Logic

Identify conditions where cross-system trust becomes degraded, unjustified, inconsistent, or governance-invalid.

### 4. Define Governance Response

Define governance actions for trust verification, operational restriction, trust recovery, escalation, or termination of trusted interaction.

### 5. Preserve Trust Traceability

Preserve trust assessments, governance decisions, operational evidence, trust history, and supporting documentation.

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## Use Case 1 — Autonomous Smart Logistics Network

### Scenario

Independent logistics providers operate autonomous vehicles that exchange cargo and operational responsibilities.

## Application

CSTM governs the trust relationships required before autonomous operational cooperation is permitted.

## Result

Cross-company autonomous operations remain trustworthy, governed, and operationally reliable.

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# Use Case 2 — Autonomous Healthcare Ecosystem

## Scenario

Autonomous diagnostic systems, robotic pharmacies, and hospital AI platforms exchange patient-related operational information.

## Application

CSTM continuously evaluates and governs trust relationships across participating autonomous systems.

## Result

Healthcare operations remain coordinated, trustworthy, and governance-compliant.

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## Canonical Closing Statement

**Governable compatibility requires governable trust. Cross-System Trust ensures that autonomous operational systems cooperate only through justified, verifiable, and continuously governed trust relationships across autonomous operational ecosystems.**

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# Related Documents

[→ Autonomous Compatibility Standard \(ACPS\)](#)

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